18.10 Opioid and Drug Withdrawal*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My whole body aches and I cannot stop yawning." **Objective** • Sweating, dilated pupils, goose bumps • Vomiting and diarrhea • Last use 18 hours ago	**ACTUAL** Acute substance withdrawal syndrome related to abrupt cessation of opioids as evidenced by diaphoresis, mydriasis, vomiting and myalgia.	• Gets through withdrawal safely with bearable symptoms.	• Score withdrawal with a validated scale such as COWS. • Give substitution or symptom-relief medication as prescribed. • Keep him hydrated. • Provide a calm setting.	• Met when withdrawal is completed safely.
Subjective • "I want to stop but I am afraid I will use again." **Objective** • Has relapsed before • Mixed feelings about treatment	**ACTUAL** Maladaptive coping related to substance dependence as evidenced by repeated relapse.	• Names his relapse triggers and sources of support.	• Use motivational interviewing. • Refer to addiction services. • Warn him that overdose risk is higher after a period without use.	• Achieved when he describes a plan.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Vomiting and diarrhea	**RISK** Risk for inadequate fluid volume as evidenced by risk factors: vomiting and diarrhea during withdrawal.	• Stays well hydrated.	• Keep an intake and output chart. • Encourage fluids; give IV fluids if ordered. • Give an antiemetic and antidiarrheal as prescribed.	• Outcome reached while he is hydrated.

*References for this care plan: [31], [35], [131], [136]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.